Mr. Lamb:
I'm old. You're young. You've got a burned face, I've got a tin leg. Not important. You're standing there.... I'm sitting here. Where's the difference?

Derry: Why have you got a tin leg?

Mr. Lamb:
Real one got blown off, years back. Lamey-Lamb, some kids say. Haven't you heard them? You will. Lamey-Lamb. It fits. Doesn't trouble me.

Derry:
But you can put on trousers and cover it up and no one sees, they don't have to notice and stare.

Mr. Lamb:
Some do. Some don't. They get tired of it, in the end. There's plenty of other things to stare at.

Derry: Like my face.

Mr. Lamb:
Like crab apples or the weeds or a spider climbing up a silken ladder, or my tall sun-flowers.

Derry: Things.

Mr. Lamb:
It's all relative. *Beauty and the Beast*.



Derry:
What's that supposed to mean?

Mr. Lamb: You tell me.

Derry:
You needn't think they haven't all told me that fairy story before. '*It's not what you look like, it's what you are inside. Handsome is as handsome does. Beauty loved the monstrous beast for himself and when she kissed him he changed into a handsome prince*.' Only he wouldn't, he'd have stayed a monstrous beast. I won't change.

Mr. Lamb: In that way? No, you won't.

Derry:
And no, one'll kiss me, ever. Only my mother, and she kisses me on the other side of my face, and I don't like my mother to kiss me, she does it because she has to. I don't care if nobody ever kisses me.It won't make my face change. Do you know, one day, a woman went by me in the street — I was at a bus-stop — and she was with another woman, and she looked at me, and she said.... whispered.... only I heard her.... she said, "Look at that, that's a terrible thing. That's a face only a mother could love."

Mr. Lamb:
So now you keep your ears shut.

Derry:
You're....peculiar. You say peculiar things. You ask questions I don't understand.

Mr. Lamb:
I like to talk. Have company. You don't have to answer questions. You don't have to stop here at all. The gate's open.

Derry: Yes, but...

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